

be vulnerable and afraid at the end of this episode when confronted with her past in the form of her mother.



- Hanne Thomsen is another example of a strong female character who is also a positive representation of an older woman who is well-respected, experienced, and good at her job. Like the other women in *The Bridge*, she is not objectified, her clothing is functional and her grey hair and serious expression aid in constructing her representation. She also exemplifies the cultural differences between Sweden and Denmark, 'From their first meeting hostilities begin to mount with Hanne showing her prejudices bordering on contempt for Swedish political correctness' (www.bbc.co.uk). She can barely disguise her disdain when interviewing Anker's wife at the idea of a gender-neutral pre-school, she describes her as 'a bit Swedish'.
- Lise Friis Anderson is powerful in a different way, she is middle class, the wife of a wealthy businessman. Her views are right-wing, and she is an opinion leader through her blog displaying her views of what constitutes a family which is in direct contrast to those of Helle Anker. She has no qualms in teaching her daughter to react with violence when bullied.

Representations of gender: Men/ Masculinity

The representations of masculinity in *The Bridge* challenge the idea of inequalities of power between men and women. The representations are not typical of crime dramas as the female characters are active and central to the narrative.

- Whilst Hans is in a hierarchically powerful position, he does not use this in an oppressive way and is understanding and supportive of those who work for him, traits that could be said to be more typically feminine. He has an equal relationship with his partner Lillian who is a strong woman. He is also a positive representation of age.



- Henrik is portrayed as a flawed, vulnerable character with issues.
- It is the men, rather than the women who are presented in domestic roles, Henrik cooks and cleans and appears to be nurturing his children, a role usually given to female characters. Lise has a male cleaner, Rikard who fulfils a domestic role.



Theoretical Approaches: Feminist theory - bell hooks and Van Zoonen

bell hooks assertion that feminism is a struggle to end sexist/patriarchal oppression and the ideology of domination can be explored in relation to *The Bridge*:

- whilst patriarchal representations of gender are still evident in crime dramas, the constructions of representations of women in *The Bridge* largely challenge bell hooks' concept of 'the ideology of domination', reflecting changing ideologies and engaging in a feminist discourse.
- Saga and Hanne challenge the norm of women in the police force as does Lillian who is the Danish Police Commissioner in Copenhagen.
- representations of the family also challenge stereotypes. Helle Anker is an LGBT spokesperson offering a positive representation of acceptance of lesbian marriage within society. Saga introduces Hanne to "Hen" as a gender-neutral pronoun reflecting changing attitudes to gender.
- men in *The Bridge* are also constructed as less dominant; Hans is gentle and caring, a father figure for Saga, and Henrik is vulnerable and coping with his own demons.